Zhalet Tapia

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EDUCATION

Rutgers University, New Brunswick May 2027
BS in Computer Science GPA 3.8/4.0 Dean's List
Relevant Coursework: Graphic Design, Software Methodology, Data Structures & Algorithms, Introduction to AI, Principles of Information & Data Management

DESIGN & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design: Figma, Wireframing, Prototyping, Heuristic Evaluation, SWOT Analysis, User Interviews
Front-End/ Technical: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Java, Python, SQL
Collaboration: Git, GitHub, Requirements Prioritization, Developer Handoff, Cross-functional Communication

UX EXPERIENCE

Extern for Kobo Projects via Rutgers MBS Externship Exchange January 2025-May 2026
UX Design Extern Remote

- Audited a live e-commerce platform using heuristic evaluation and SWOT analysis, identifying 10+ usability and performance issues previously undetected by the client team.
- Synthesized structured user interviews into prioritized product requirements, reducing ambiguity around redesign scope and stakeholder priorities.
- Created a full Figma redesign with reusable components and an interactive prototype presented directly to stakeholders as a foundation for front-end development.

Hack4Impact, Rutgers University May 2025 – Present
UI/UX Team Member & Outreach Director New Brunswick, NJ

- Selected to join the Fall 2026 UI/UX team supporting nonprofit product work while continuing to manage partner outreach and cross-functional communication.
- Built a nonprofit partner pipeline and organized events drawing 30+ student developers, strengthening collaboration between technical teams and community organizations.

PROJECTS

T&T Certified Translation Services August 2026-Present

- Designing the end-to-end customer experience across Home, Pricing, Place Order, FAQ, payment, and confirmation flows for a certified translation-service MVP.
- Designed an admin experience for order review, document inspection, translation review, notes, and status management while keeping customer checkout registration-free.
- Translating product flows into reusable Next.js/JavaScript UI components and connecting the design to Supabase-backed data and Stripe Checkout.

LEADERSHIP

Ecuadorian Roots in America (REA), Rutgers University New Brunswick, NJ
Secretary 2026-Present
Co-Outreach Chair 2025-2026

- Coordinate organizational communications, meeting documentation, and event planning while supporting leadership operations for the student organization.
- Previously led outreach and logistics for 10+ events per semester averaging 40+ attendees and helped launch 3 campus diversity and inclusion initiatives.

Pachamama Juice and Smoothies January 2025 - Present
Assistant Manager Highlands, NJ

- Rebuilt daily operational workflows for a 10+ person team, measurably reducing process errors and increasing order throughput during peak hours.